EPISTOLA AD EMUM P. D. EUGENIUM, TIT. SS. SILVESTRI ET MARTINI, S. R. E. PRESB. CARD. TOSI ARCHIEPISCOPUM MEDIOLANENSEM, QUEM DELIGIT LEGATUM SUUM AD CORONAS IMPONENDAS INFANTI IESU ET BEATAE VIRGINI DE FONTANELLATO, IN DIOECESI PARMENSI.

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EPISTOLA

AD EMUM P. D. EUGENIUM, TIT. SS. SILVESTRI ET MARTINI, S. R. E. PRESB. CARD. TOSI ARCHIEPISCOPUM MEDIOLANENSEM, QUEM DELIGIT LEGATUM SUUM AD CORONAS IMPONENDAS INFANTI IESU ET BEATAE VIRGINI DE FONTANELLATO, IN DIOECESI PARMENSI.

D i l e c t e fili N o s t e r , s a l u t e m et apostolicam benedictionem. — Quod S a n c t u a r i i d e F o n t a n e l l a t o laus a c f a m a n o n m o d o in dioecesis P a r m e n s i s t o t i u s q u e A e m i l i a e finibus percrebrescit, sed e t i a m a p u d e x t e r a s g e n t e s - q u a c u m q u e missionales e Sodalitate Parmensi a Francisco Xaverio in e t h n i c o s Christo lucrandos i n c u m b u n t - mirari cui liceat * q u a n d o , trium d e c u r s u s a e c u l o r u m , a B e a t i s s i m a Virgine, cuius s i m u l a c r u m p u b l i c a e ibi est v e n e r a t i o n i p r o p o s i t u m , t o t t a m q u e mirabilia christianus p o p u l u s b e n e - f i c i a i m p e t r a v i t ? N a m q u e , u t maiores m e m o r i a e prodiderunt, e t m o n u m e n - tis r e c e n t i o r u m a e t a t u m c o m m e n d a t u m est, Virgine d e F o n t a n e l l a t o depre- catrice s a e p e n u m e r o contigit, u t a d f i d e m b o n a m v e frugem h o m i n e s a t q u e a d s a n i t a t e m e x i m p r o v i s o reverterentur, praetereaque d a m n a e t pericula effugerent, q u a e sibi suisque rebus i m p e n d e r e n t . C o m p e r i m u s i t e m , prae- c i p u o q u o d a m a m a n t i s s i m a e Matris patrocinio pueros eius regionis a d h u n c d i e m fruitos esse: feruntur e n i m ahi, in p u t e o s fossasque delapsi, i n c o l u m e s i n d e emersisse, i m p a c i t i alii rotis g r a v i s s i m o r u m curruum, integri exsi- l u i s s e a t q u e intacti; alii a u t caeci a n a t i v i t a t e a u t m u t i et surdi a u t m e m b r i s c a p t i d e b i l e s q u e v i s u m , v o c e m , a u d i t u m m o t u m q u e recuperasse. Q u o r u m profecto m i r a c u l o r u m l u c u l e n t o s u n t t e s t i m o n i o c u m t a b u l a e v o t i v a e , qui- b u s sacrae A e d i s parietes v e s t i u n t u r toti, t u m i n g e n s peregrinorum m u l t i - t u d o , qui q u o t a n n i s , praesertim m e n s i b u s augusto et septembri, pedibus i n t e r d u m , v e l nudis, iter ingressi, u n d i q u e illuc, implorationis g r a t i v e a n i m i ergo, c o n v e n i u n t . N e c , d i l e c t e f i l i N o s t e r , ignoras, q u e m u t e r q u e h a b u i m u s i n archidioecesi r e g u n d a decessorem, s . m . P a t r e m Cardinalem A n d r e a m Ferrari, n o n t a m o b v e t e r e m clericorum P a r m e n s i u m c o n s u e t u d i n e m , q u a m q u i a a e g r o t a n s puerulus, m a t r e sua a n t e S i m u l a c r u m in preces l a c r i m a s q u e effusa, a d s a n i t a t e m r e s t i t u t u s erat, n o v e n s i l e m s a c e r d o t e m ibi p r i m u m l i t a s s e et s a l t e m s e m e l in a n n o litare p o s t e a eonsuevisse: a q u o p i a e ' m e m b - risque v o l u n t a t i s officio i p s u m n e c operosa gregis cura n e c is, q u o d e m u m a b r e p t u s est, m o r b u s u n q u a m detinuerunt. Quodsi t a h a D e i G e n e t r i x beneficia eo l o c o fidelibus a b u n d e c o n t i n e n t e r q u e largitur, misericordiae Virginis c o n g r u u n t sane a c r e s p o n d e n t popularis p i e t a t i s argumenta ac

significationes. Cuius q u i d e m rei t e s t e m appellari adhiberique liceat P a r - m e n s e m A n t i s t i t e m , cui, e x collata c o m m u n i t e r stipe, c o p i a e f a c u l t a t e s q u e suppetiere t u m ad s a n c t u a r i u m - a b h i n c duos et v i g i n t i a n n o s B a s i l i c a e titulo a u c t u m - n o v a et magnifica fronte o r n a n d u m , t u m ad coronas affabre conficiendas ac c a e l a n d a s , quibus D e i p a r a e et I n f a n t i s I e s u c a p i t a d e c r e t u m est l o n g e sollemniore ritu redimiri q u a m annis MDCLX et MDCCLXXI f a c t u m est. Cum a u t e m u t e i u s m o d i e v e n t u m , N o s t r a inter p o s i t a auctori- t a t e , participaremus, a venerabili fratre A r c h i e p i s c o p o E p i s c o p o P a r m e n s i , a Moderatoribus D o m i n i c i a n a e familiae, q u a e d i v i n u m c u l t u m a n i m a r u m - q u e s a l u t e m in B a s i l i c a p r o v e h i t , i t e m q u e a primoribus cleri p o p u l i q u e rogati simus, placuit e o r u n d e m o p t a t i s b e n i g n e concedere. I t a q u e t e , dilecte f i l i N o s t e r , q u e m a d m o d u m praemoneri i u s s i m u s , L e g a t u m N o - s t r u m deligimus ac r e n u n t i a m u s , qui sacris sollemnibus m e n s e m a i o Par- m a e h a b e n d i s N o s t r o n o m i n e praesideas, e t coronas, quas prius N o s m e t ipsi prece s a n c t a lustrabimus> Virgini de F o n t a n e l l a t o et I n f a n t i I e s u , q u e m I p s a in ulnis sustinet, v e l u t i m a n i b u s N o s t r i s i m p o n a s . Q u a m q u i d e m a d L e g a t i o n e m a m p l i s s i m a m u t t e v o c a r e m u s , suaserunt et N o s t r a i n t e b e n e - v o l e n t i a e caritas e t p i e t a s in V i r g i n e m tua; a t p o t i s s i m u m e a N o s i m p u l i t c o g i t a t i o , decere o m n i n o , q u o d in m e m o r i a m decessoris Cardinalis Perrari a e n e u m e r e c t u m est in area B a s i l i c a e

m o n u m e n t u m , illud a te d e t e g i ac dedicari. Q u o d igitur in dioecesi P a r m e n s i N o s t r a m per a g e n d a solle mnia sustinebis p e r s o n a m , idcirco t u u m q u o q u e erit, eos o m n e s qui c o n v e n e r i n t N o s t r i s verbis alioqui, i i s d e m q u e a d m o v e r e s t i m u l o s , u t , f l a g r a n t i i n Virgi- n e m d e F o n t a n e l l a t o p i e t a t e c h r i s t i a n a r u m q u e v i r t u t u m studio, s e eius patrocinio cotidie digniores e x h i b e a n t ac p r a e s t e n t . Caelestium i n t e r e a d o n o r u m a u s p i c e m p a t e r n a e q u e caritatis N o s t r a e t e s t e m , tibi, d i l e c t e f i l i N o s t e r , e t A n t i s t i t i , clero p o p u l o q u e dioecesis P a r m e n s i s a p o s t o l i c a m b e n e - dictionem peramanter impertimus. D a t u m B o m a e a p u d S a n c t u m P e t r u m , die VII m e n s i s martii, a n n o MDCCCCXXV, Pontificatus N o s t r i q u a r t o .

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